

First Name: **Minkyo** / Last Name: **Kim**

Date of Birth: Aug. 10th, 2010

Applying Grades: 9th on campus

Dear Admission Office at Peddie School,

Here are links for supplemental documents to help you better understand who I really am.

Personal Website: <https://www.caelumplena.com/minkyokim>

Personal Introduction Video: <https://youtu.be/EdFrM-SigOs>

3D Virtual Space:

https://www.spatial.io/s/minkyo_kims-Immersive-Hangout-671f38e361313868cda81355?share=7526142686272412592

Athletic Introduction: <https://youtu.be/ZyquDOyuKos>

1. Image Atlas (Art & Environmentalism & Journalism)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1hWke9_5Plc72_KWX5HcWhn27pEnc4pc-/view?usp=drive_link

An image atlas is a narrative constructed through juxtaposing seemingly distinct artworks or photographs. In my atlas, I've brought together Choi Wooram's Round Table, a photo that I took during the impeachment protest of the President of South Korea, and Claude Monet's Haystacks. My recent experience at the impeachment protest was the inspiration for this project. (Surprisingly and shamefully, in South Korea, on December 3rd, 2024, martial law was abruptly declared by the president of the Republic of Korea to remove his political rivals.) At first glance, these images seem unrelated to each other, yet they have a penetrating theme that links them with each other: Order Amidst Chaos, the sustainable act for future generations, and the role that humans play as both the destructor and preserver.

2. Photo Journalism (Photography & Journalism)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1tIkRylMb2aThkj3DbmbeVnxuN7dK9wcl/view?usp=drive_link

My photojournalism aims to emphasize the ongoing struggle for Democracy in South Korea. By mentioning the history of dictatorship, resistance, and people's fight for democracy, I tried to illustrate how the tumultuous history of democracy has dramatically formed this country. Moreover, the title 'Light Against Darkness' directly shows the impeachment assembly of Korea from contrasting perspectives. In the past, Koreans suffered from two consecutive dictatorships, which can be expressed as the age of darkness, but the hopeful light for democracy has never stopped. Reflecting that history repeats itself, the new light in 2024 representing the lightsticks of K-POP throws away the old darkness dawned by anachronistic President Yun's martial law declaration.

Unlike other students participating in popular sports such as basketball, baseball, and soccer, I've been committed to the sport of rowing as a Varsity Crew. As a team captain and member of the first crew team of international schools in Korea, I've participated in several national-level competitions held in Korea in 2024, including the Misari Rowing Competition and Chungju Rowing Competition by winning quadruple & single sculling 2nd. Also, attending the Independence Day Regatta 2023, where our team was the first Asian amateur crew varsity, we directly experienced the meaning of diversity in the international competition.

The Link to Minkyo's Crew Performance: <https://youtu.be/ZyquDOyuKos>

The Link to Misari Competition: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wtiA5kOVKZU>

3. Passaic Research Paper (Rowing & Environmentalism)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1P02Xo6aPSw7C7rMFf6bZNsSuC2wqKh6K/view?usp=drive_link

Since rowing is an environmentally friendly sport closely related to protecting clean water, I've also tried to connect my athletic experience to academic research on environmentalism, especially the nature of water. The linked PDF file '*Passaic_Research_Paper_MinkyoKim*' is a monument to my dedication to raising awareness of pollution in the Passaic River, NJ, where our rowing varsity team was trained for Independence Day Regatta 2023. The following link also shows our sincere effort to collect trash on the river by using an aquatic cleaning device named "Pet-Net."

The Link to *Trash Net Project of inventing "Pet-Net"*:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8-gLbjubqis>

The Link to *Sports - Environmental Campaign and Challenge*:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5WFgVw8y1bs>

4. K-Environmentalism Magazine (History & Environmentalism)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1sOqURN3GwUpDbXINlqDXL8uTROWbSVog/view?usp=drive_link

I have participated in environmentalist projects that promote public support and awareness of environmental issues worldwide. From *Trash Net Project* to *Sports - Environmental Campaign*, "Row for Pure, Cut through Sweat," I've manifested my enthusiasm for environmentalism to the public over time. Following the successful publication of the first K-environmentalism magazine covering Korea's own environmentally friendly culture & customs, I've been working on an appendix version of the publication as an environmental journalism project.

Focusing on the significance of Getbol (Korea's characteristic Mudflat) and Byeotjip (Korea's own Straw Stack) from the perspective of Carbon Neutrality consistently promoted by the Korean Government, I wrote about Nature's own sustainability process under anaerobic conditions, limited oxygen availability and methane suppression, and Human's environmentally-friendly effort to regenerate cellulose fibers. By publicizing Korea's unique circumstances of preservation, I wrote about how Korean environmentalism reflected on Getbol and Butjip can be an exemplary model for solving the global environmental crisis.

5. Performing Art (Light Drawing: Plum Blossoms on Water)

<https://youtu.be/DB7wOGGaxU>

Light Drawing is a work that captures the instant movement of light within a single image. For this project, I used various body actions to express the blooming of plum blossoms. Since plum blossom, the flower of the plum tree native to East Asia, symbolizes resilience and endurance as it blooms in the harshness of winter, I tried to make a symbolic image of a light drawing that overcomes adversity and renewal in a water environment.

6. World Rowing Participation

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1SP8E4gOmRr6XPDPctuCRLv077YL73iFV/view?usp=drive_link

Through the winter of 2023 - 2024, our Varsity Crew has continued working on the sport of rowing through virtual competitions. Fortunately, we were able to be qualified as finalists in 2024 World Rowing Indoor Championships' Team Relay Men (2000m relay virtual). Out of all the participants around the world, our team won 4th place, with the personally best record in world-level competitions.

I hope my deep passion for art, photography, journalism, rowing, and environmentalism will enrich the inclusive community of Peddie School. If you need further questions about linked documents, please contact me at minkyokim@caelumprep.com

Thank you for your kind time and consideration.

Respectfully yours,

Minkyoo Kim

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EDUCATION & ACADEMICS

Providence Christian Academy Korea

20, Dogok-ro 23-gil, Gangnam-gu, Seoul, Republic of Korea

(6th ~ 8th) January 2022 - June 2025

Varsity (<https://youtu.be/ZyquDOyuKos>)

(Varsity) Crew

Mar 2022 - Present

Stroke Pair & Team Captain (<https://youtu.be/wtiA5kOVKZU>)

- As a founding member of the Rowing team, guided and motivated teammates during training sessions to improve intermediate techniques of rowing, such as feathering and squaring, along with sportsmanship and teamwork.
- As the USRowing Member of the first Crew in Korea, attended the Independence Regatta 2023 in Philadelphia and the indoor world rowing event. As a leading member of KISRA (Korea International School Rowing Association), attended and won domestic competitions in Chungju and Misari, winning single 2nd, quadruple 2nd, and indoor ergometer 2nd place.

ACTIVITIES (*Introduction Video LINK: <https://youtu.be/EdFrM-SigOs>*)

Student Council

August 2024 - Present

Class President

- As a leading position, coordinated school events such as spiritual emphasis day, sports day, and school trips by efficient communication among student council members while delivering direct suggestions to the school admin office.

Social Movement: Concert for Peace Protest

Mar 2022 - Jun 2022

Assistant Staff of Volunteers (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qm9A8EpcWGE>)

- Led by professor Il-Hwan Bae and other professional musicians from Ewha Womans University, Concert for Peace is a musical protest for peace in Ukraine, held at 12 pm every day before the Russian Embassy in Korea.
- Created anti-war posters and participated in non-violent demonstrations by picketing during the musical performances, publicizing protest recordings, and advocating interviews via Instagram and YouTube.

UN Forum - For Human Rights in North Korea

Sep 2022 - Jun 2023

Delegate of Food Security and Healthcare Department (<https://youtu.be/Vnb9iVCoeRA>)

- Proposed plan to assist the Humanitarian Crisis in North Korea while exchanging ideas for a cooperative solution, researching the food insecurity and malnutrition of North Korea while highlighting bureaucratic abuse of agriculture.

UN Forum - For the Harmonious Assimilation of Refugee and the Hosting Country

Aug 2023 - Present

Event Organizer of SDG 8, 9, 11 (<https://youtu.be/A56R0LkPSaU>)

- As an event organizer of SDG 8 (Decent work and economic growth), 9 (Industry Innovation), and 11 (Sustainable Cities), discussed the cooperation of UNHCR and the Turkish government regarding stable employment of refugees along with practical solutions via the construction of infrastructure and international relationships with nearby countries.
- Issued Forum Reports to the committee about assimilation of the refugee community via financial and citizenship support.

PROJECTS(*Spatial 3D LINK*)

Caelum Plena

Jun 2023 - Present

Environment & Athletic Lead (<https://www.caelumplena.com/minkyokim>)

- For Caelum Plena Projects, promotions of independent creators' works of inspiration under the categories including Art, Environment, and Social Movement, promoted senses-artworks by converting classical music into visual artwork and developing creative space with light drawing inspired by Picasso's improvised artwork.
- Led the identity projects through the "Scenic" project of photojournalism and "The Chair" project.
- Designed blueprints of a rowing dock for the disabled who have to use wheelchairs right before sitting on the shell.
- Re-designed the icon of Sustainable Development Goals(UN SDGs) number 4(Quality Education), 6(Clean Water and Sanitation), 10(Reduced Inequalities), 12(Responsible Consumption and Production), and 17(Partnership for the Goals).
- Supplied 2 boxes of necessities for Türkiye Relief Effort for the displaced by the massive earthquake in Türkiye.
- Managed a pop-up store at Misari Regatta to help donate schools for children in Senegal suffering from climate change.

Clean Water Project: Row for Pure, Cut through Sweat

Nov 2023 - Present

Managing Director of the Project (<https://youtu.be/fKv5-L8ZTfU>)

- Inspired by cleaning up rivers and oceans, led the Trash Net System project, which aims to promote environmentalism among rowers by creating devices that collect trash on the water with rowing boats.
- Created the Pet Net, the first prototype of Trash Net System attached to the two rowing boats to collect trash.

Photo Journalism Project: Scenic

Jul 2024 - Sep 2024

Creative Director (<https://readymag.website/u89249189/4916980/>)

- Created 'Scenic', an environmental journal webpage that highlights the insinuated meanings of photos to raise awareness regarding environmental mutualism between nature and urbanity: harmonious assimilation and interconnectedness.

New York UN SDGs Workshop

Jun 2023 - Jul 2023

Leading Participant (<https://youtu.be/frc7-LXlrw>)

- Integrating Architecture, Business, and Robotics, sought for the practical methodology to solve the impending problems suggested by 17 UN SDGs, by communicating the current Risk Operationist of the Federal Reserve Bank to acquire the macroeconomic perspective on flow of currency and economic-politics relationship, by visiting Grace Farm, Glass House, Chelsea Market, Hudson Yard, and High Line which symbolize the ideal restoration of abandoned urban facilities, and absorbing comprehension about A.I. through the interaction with a robotics expert from the AI farming company, Zordi.
- Created a blueprint of a community accommodation facility that contributes to the successful execution of SDGs 4 (Quality Education) and 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities).

Short Film Festival: Drug Education in Korea

Jun 2023 - Jul 2023

Assistant Staff of Hyunkyo Kim (older brother) (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DCXQm8zZ1hM>)

- Analyzed case studies about drug abuse in Korea, assisting production of a fake documentary including interviews with drug abuse victims for the pedagogical purpose of teenagers, warning fentanyl crisis in South Korea, the United States, and Japan.

VOLUNTEERS

Misari Para-Rowing Competition

Oct 2022 - Present

Leading Assistant of the Volunteers (<https://youtu.be/afLzslYMqoQ>)

- At Misari Para-Rowing Event for the disabled eager to learn rowing, as a leading assistant, arranged the settings for the event, prepared oars and ergometers, aligned single skulls, and guided the overall exercising process of the participants.

Green Whale Global Plogging

Jun 2022 - Present

Leading Assistant of the Volunteers (<https://youtu.be/o2REfMaHlMM>)

- Sponsored by "Green Whale Global," joined the Han River Cleaning and Seoul Park Cleaning, picking up wastes into renewable plastic bags, and publicizing the seriousness of environmental problems in Seoul.

RESEARCH PAPER

Publication

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1orJlZL9_GS8qUevN8Er8pXBxJneJ5q34/view?usp=sharing

2023

- Researched how the Han dynasty can be interpreted as Defensive Imperialism, related to nomads and settlers in Asia

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1h9hb9htIm_F4C9tWVaaKaBX33-XQPuh4/view?usp=sharing

2024

- Researched the rise of Islam by analyzing the collapse of Byzantine and Sassanid Empires in the 7th century.

CERTIFICATION

Certification of First Aid for Youth Course

July 2024

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1dR9JQu12ISwwebn1kcQt4OvJyOoqTSKV/view?usp=sharing>

- Completed a certified education in first aid for emergency situations. Learned CPR, AED, and other emergency guidelines through real-field training and was awarded the Certification of First Aid for Youth Course by the Red Cross.

HONORS AND RECOGNITION

2024 World Rowing Championships' Team Relay Men (2000m relay virtual): Indoor Rowing 4th Place

Misari Rowing Regatta 2024: Indoor Rowing 2nd Place

Misari Rowing Regatta 2024: Single Sculling 2nd Place

Misari Rowing Regatta 2024: Double Sculling 2nd Place

Misari Rowing Regatta 2024: Quadruple Sculling 3rd Place

Chungju Rowing Regatta 2023: Quadruple Sculling 3rd Place